Teacher and cover plan — Refining technique through structured critique

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 1 · Big question: How do we use criteria-led critique to test material refinements and resolve our final identity outcome?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Audit your developing identity artwork against four summative criteria: Compositional balance, Tonal range, Edge precision, and Symbolic clarity.

• Conduct a structured peer critique to isolate one high-leverage technical refinement.

• Test the refinement on a live studio swatch before resolving the final identity piece.

Studio kit: Developing identity artworks, Week 1-3 portfolio sheets, A3 heavy cartridge/mount boards, full wet/dry studio media, swatch cards, critique matrices

Arrival and starter

Arrival: Why is a criteria-led critique ('Check the 5-value tonal range at the focal point') far more helpful than asking 'Do you like it?'

Starter question: What should you do if a peer critique suggests adding a bold white gouache or pastel highlight rim, and you are unsure how it will react with your ink wash?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Complete the four-criteria diagnostic: My critique partner and I score my identity piece against the four criteria and identify that the mid-tone pattern competes with my central motif.

Step 2: Run a 6 cm refinement swatch: On a scrap swatch card, I test glazing a translucent indigo wash over the background pattern while lifting the motif edge with opaque warm ochre.

Step 3: Resolve the final artwork and document: The swatch creates instant depth, so I apply the glaze and highlight rim to my final piece, then mount the swatch on my critique log.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: Criteria checked, swatch tested, final identity piece resolved, and critique sheet completed.

Independent: Peer audit recorded, live swatch verified, final artwork resolved/mounted, and technical evaluation written.

Aspire: Dual comparative swatches, exhibition-grade resolution, and critical synthesis across Weeks 1-4.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Provide 6 cm x 6 cm heavy cartridge swatch squares on every table and model how to test a translucent glaze and opaque highlight before touching the main piece.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review how to facilitate a four-criteria peer critique and live swatch verification.